strengthened its partnership with Vietnam, providing it with sophisticated weaponry and participating with it in hydrocarbons projects in areas of the South China Sea claimed by China. The most recent example was the conduct of drilling operations in the Nam Con Son Basin by the Russian state-owned oil major Rosneft on a contract from the Vietnamese government. China protested strongly to Vietnam. Undeterred by a tense faceoff between Chinese and Vietnamese Coast Guard vessels, Rosneft continued drilling. Significantly, the Chinese protest was directed only at Vietnam, not at Russia.[24] President Putin has personally engaged with Japanese Prime Minister Abe to repair Russia–Japan relations by exploring ways to settle their dispute over the Kurile islands. He has invited Japan and Korea to invest in Russia's Far East and has talked about the importance of their role in promoting stability and security in the Asia-Pacific. In June 2016, Putin unveiled a "Greater Eurasia" plan to develop Eurasia into a Russia-centric pole in the world order, diluting China's influence by inclusion of other Asian countries.[25] Russian analysts, including many with links to President Putin, have fleshed out this concept, projecting it as a blueprint for a new geostrategic community of development and security, drawing in erst-while Eurasian adversaries into a cooperative relationship. Its principal objective has been described as placing China in "a pool of ties, cooperation institutions, balances and agreements" that would prevent it from exercising hegemony, which would be unacceptable to regional countries like Japan, Korea, and India.[26] This may be an overly ambitious goal, given Russia's current diplomatic possibilities, but it does reveal some convergence in Indian and Russian perspectives on the required ingredients for a stable Indo-Pacific economic and security architecture.

India's membership of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) and the Free Trade Agreement (FTA)